

Lab 3.3.10 Report: Create User Accounts

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Part 1: Creating a New Local User Account

Question 1: What type of user account did you just create?

Answer:

I created a Standard User account. By default, when creating a new local user account through the Settings interface in Windows, the account is created with Standard User privileges. This type of account has limited permissions and cannot make system-wide changes, install software that affects all users, or modify other users' accounts without administrator credentials.

Question 2: Which groups or users have full control of this folder?

Answer:

The following users and groups have full control of the User1 folder:

1. User1 (the owner of the folder)
2. SYSTEM (the Windows operating system account)
3. Administrators group (all users who are members of the local Administrators group)

User1 has full control over their own profile folder to manage personal files and settings. The SYSTEM account needs access for system operations,

and the Administrators group has full control to manage all user profiles for administrative purposes.

Question 3: Were you able to access the folder? Explain.

Answer:

No, I was not able to access the CyberOpsUser folder. When I attempted to open it, Windows displayed an "Access Denied" error message stating "You don't currently have permission to access this folder."

This happened because User1 is a Standard User account and does not have permissions to access other users' personal folders. Windows protects user privacy by restricting access to user profile folders. Only the folder owner, the SYSTEM account, and members of the Administrators group can access a user's personal folder. This security feature prevents unauthorized access to personal files and maintains user privacy.

Question 4: Which groups or users have full control of this folder?

Answer:

The following groups and accounts have full control of the C:\Users folder:

1. SYSTEM (the Windows system account)
2. Administrators group (local administrators)

Additionally, the following have partial permissions:

- Users group (Read & Execute, List folder contents, Read)
- CREATOR OWNER (special permissions for subfolders)

The C:\Users folder is a parent directory containing all user profile folders, so it requires more restrictive permissions than individual user folders. Only SYSTEM and Administrators have full control to ensure system integrity and proper management of all user profiles.

Part 2: Reviewing User Account Properties

Question 5: Which group is User1 is a member of?

Answer:

User1 is a member of the Users group. This is the default group assignment for Standard User accounts in Windows. Members of the Users group have basic permissions to run applications, access their own files, and perform common tasks, but they cannot make system-wide changes, install software for all users, or modify system settings without administrative privileges.

Question 6: Which group is this user a member of?

Answer:

CyberOpsUser is a member of the Administrators group. Users in the Administrators group have complete control over the computer and can make any changes to system settings, install and uninstall software, access all files on the computer, create and manage other user accounts, and perform any administrative tasks. This group has the highest level of privileges on a local Windows system.

Part 3: Modifying Local User Accounts

Question 7: Which groups does User1 belong to?

Answer:

After changing the account type to Administrator, User1 now belongs to two groups:

1. Users group (retained from before)
2. Administrators group (newly added)

This dual membership gives User1 both the basic user permissions and full administrative privileges. Being a member of the Administrators group grants User1 complete control over the system, allowing them to make system-wide changes, install software, manage other accounts, and access all system resources.

Question 8: What is another way to delete a user account?

Answer:

There are several other ways to delete a user account in Windows:

1. Through Control Panel:

Control Panel > User Accounts > Manage another account > Select the user > Delete the account

2. Through Settings (Windows 10/11):

Settings > Accounts > Family & other users > Select the user > Remove

3. Using Command Prompt (as Administrator):

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net user User1 /delete
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4. Using PowerShell (as Administrator):

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Remove-LocalUser -Name "User1"
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Each method achieves the same result but offers different levels of access and control. The GUI methods (Control Panel/Settings) are more user-friendly, while command-line methods are faster and can be scripted for automation.

Reflection Questions

Question 9: Why is it important to protect all accounts with strong passwords?

Answer:

Protecting all accounts with strong passwords is critical for several reasons:

1. Prevents Unauthorized Access: Strong passwords make it extremely difficult for attackers to guess or crack passwords using brute-force or dictionary attacks.
2. Protects Personal Data: User accounts contain sensitive personal information, documents, emails, and files that should remain private.

3. Prevents System Compromise: Administrator accounts with weak passwords can lead to complete system takeover, allowing attackers to install malware, steal data, or damage the system.
4. Maintains System Integrity: Even standard user accounts need protection because compromised accounts can be used as stepping stones to escalate privileges or spread malware.
5. Compliance Requirements: Many organizations and regulations (like GDPR, HIPAA) require strong password policies to protect data.
6. Defense in Depth: Strong passwords are a fundamental layer in a multi-layered security approach.

A strong password should be at least 12-16 characters long, include uppercase and lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters, and should not contain dictionary words or personal information.

Question 10: Why would you create a user with Standard privileges?

Answer:

Creating users with Standard privileges (rather than Administrator privileges) is a security best practice for several important reasons:

1. Principle of Least Privilege: Users should only have the minimum permissions necessary to perform their tasks. Standard accounts provide

sufficient access for everyday computing without unnecessary elevated privileges.

2. Limits Malware Damage: If a Standard user account is compromised by malware, the damage is contained to that user's profile. The malware cannot make system-wide changes, install drivers, or affect other users.
3. Prevents Accidental System Changes: Standard users cannot accidentally delete critical system files, uninstall important software, or modify system settings that could break the operating system.
4. User Account Control (UAC) Protection: When a Standard user needs to perform administrative tasks, they must provide administrator credentials, creating an additional security checkpoint.
5. Reduces Attack Surface: With fewer accounts having administrative rights, there are fewer potential entry points for attackers to gain full system control.
6. Organizational Security: In business environments, limiting administrative access helps maintain security policies and compliance requirements.
7. Accountability: When administrative actions require explicit elevation, it's easier to track and audit who performed what administrative tasks.

Administrator accounts should only be used when necessary for system maintenance, software installation, or configuration changes. For daily work, even IT professionals should use Standard accounts.